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MySQL NULL Values

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What is a NULL Value?

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If a field in a table is optional, it is possible to insert or update a record without adding any value to this field. This way, the field will be saved with a `NULL` value.

A `NULL` value represents an unknown, missing, or inapplicable data in a database field. It is not a value itself, but a placeholder to indicate the absence of data.

Note: A `NULL` value is different from zero (0) or an empty string (''). A field with a `NULL` value is one that has been left blank upon record creation.

How to Test for NULL Values?

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IS NULL Syntax

```
SELECT column_names
FROM table_name
WHERE column_name IS NULL;
```

IS NOT NULL Syntax

```
SELECT column_names
FROM table_name
WHERE column_name IS NOT NULL;
```

Demo Database

Below is a selection from the "Customers" table in the Northwind sample database:

CustomerID	CustomerName	ContactName	Address	City	PostalCode	Co
1	Alfreds Futterkiste	Maria Anders	Obere Str. 57	Berlin	12209	Ge
2	Ana Trujillo Emparedados y helados	Ana Trujillo	Avda. de la Constitución 2222	México D.F.	05021	Me
3	Antonio Moreno Taquería	Antonio Moreno	Mataderos 2312	México D.F.	05023	Me

	snabbköp	Berglund	8				

The IS NULL Operator

The `IS NULL` operator is used to test for empty values (NULL values).

The following SQL lists all customers with a NULL value in the "Address" field:

Example

```
SELECT CustomerName, ContactName, Address
FROM Customers
WHERE Address IS NULL;
```

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Tip: Always use `IS NULL` to look for NULL values.

The IS NOT NULL Operator

The `IS NOT NULL` operator is used to test for non-empty values (NOT NULL values).

The following SQL lists all customers with a value in the "Address" field:

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```
SELECT CustomerName, ContactName, Address
FROM Customers
WHERE Address IS NOT NULL;
```

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